

Chapter 6

Yan Si woke up early in the morning, covering her aching nape and glaring at Yin Lingzhu who was still asleep.

This person had shown no mercy when biting, causing her such pain.

But she couldn't deny that the feeling of released pheromones was quite nice. She had rarely slept so well last night, and the oppressive feeling in her chest had also dissipated.

This little Alpha was actually quite good.

Thinking this, Yan Si put on her clothes and left.

She had many scenes to film today.

Yin Lingzhu only woke up at noon, feeling weak and powerless in her limbs, not wanting to move at all.

She turned her head - the bed beside her was already empty.

Yin Lingzhu propped herself up to get out of bed. To capture a person's heart, you must first capture their stomach¹.

Previously, she had always ordered takeout or eaten out casually, dealing with meals carelessly. Now she needed to work hard to learn cooking skills.

She aimed to capture Yan Si's heart, so that the first thing she could see when waking up the next day would be Yan Si's face.

Thinking this, she felt full of energy.

At three in the afternoon, Yin Lingzhu returned from the supermarket with a pile of seasonings and vegetables.

She confidently opened cooking videos and began following them. After trying all afternoon, she began to doubt herself for the first time.

In her previous world, the code she could write casually was what others would struggle for days to figure out.

Client satisfaction with her software was also the highest.

She had clearly followed the tutorial to make the food, but what came out was completely inedible.

With an attitude of refusing to believe in failure, Yin Lingzhu tried again, and indeed it tasted terrible.

She struggled to swallow the last bite of vegetables, thinking of solutions.

Was it the vegetables' fault?

This thought flashed through Yin Lingzhu's mind.

She had only bought vegetables - she should buy some meat and such.

Yin Lingzhu ran to the supermarket, only to discover it was already dark. She had spent so much time cooking in the afternoon.

Looking at the dazzling array of meat, Yin Lingzhu's mind was in chaos, not knowing which to choose.

"Lawyer Ji." When Yin Lingzhu was at a loss, she unexpectedly saw Ji Jingrong there too.

Yin Lingzhu waved her hand. "Over here."

Ji Jingrong was picking vegetables when she heard someone call her name and looked up to see her client.

Seeing Ji Jingrong notice her, she hurriedly went toward her.

"Lawyer Ji, could you help me pick vegetables? I can pay you."

Yin Lingzhu remembered saying she would give Ji Jingrong half of the company's compensation money, and her eyes had lit up - she must really value money.

Or perhaps that half of the money made her very satisfied.

Ji Jingrong heard her request and didn't refuse, also saying she didn't need payment.

Learning that Yin Lingzhu was a beginner, she not only picked fresh meat for her but also thoughtfully recommended easy-to-learn dishes.

After Yin Lingzhu checked out and left, she unexpectedly discovered that Ji Jingrong was going the same way.

"Where does Lawyer Ji live?" Yin Lingzhu asked.

Ji Jingrong also noticed they were taking the same route.

"I'm in Apartment A, room 2315," Ji Jingrong said.

"What a coincidence, I'm also in Apartment A, room 2316," Yin Lingzhu said in surprise.

Yin Lingzhu hadn't expected to have such a connection with Ji Jingrong.

"Then let's go back together," Yin Lingzhu suggested proactively.

"Alright," Ji Jingrong agreed.

On the way back to the apartment, the two kept discussing contract issues, mainly with Ji Jingrong talking and Yin Lingzhu listening.

"Bye bye," Yin Lingzhu said to Ji Jingrong as she opened her door.

Ji Jingrong wanted to say "goodbye" to Yin Lingzhu, but she had too many things in her hands. Not paying attention, everything scattered on the ground.

"Let me help you," Yin Lingzhu said after seeing this. She placed the meat on the table by the entrance and helped pick everything up.

At the supermarket, she hadn't really looked at what Ji Jingrong bought.

Now she discovered that most of what she bought were also cooking ingredients.

"Let me hold them for you, you open the door," Yin Lingzhu gathered everything into her arms.

Perhaps because Ji Jingrong felt a bit embarrassed, she didn't say a word while lowering her head to unlock the door.

Yin Lingzhu didn't enter the room. Seeing Ji Jingrong open the door, she handed over the plastic bags.

Ji Jingrong took the items, thanked her, then quickly closed the door.

Yin Lingzhu looked at the suddenly closed door, somewhat puzzled, then turned sideways to return to her own room.

She put the meat in the kitchen and discovered that Yan Si had already returned.

But it was only eight o'clock today.

She had neither cooked nor bought food today.

Yin Lingzhu had to tell her the truth.

After listening, Yan Si said nothing and silently walked into the kitchen, preparing to cook herself.

Actually, she wasn't clear why she had come to this apartment either.

Yin Lingzhu stood outside the kitchen, watching Yan Si intently, feeling great satisfaction in her heart.

Yan Si's every move tugged at her heartstrings.

"My food is ready," Yan Si said to the dazed Yin Lingzhu.

"You make your own food."

As soon as Yin Lingzhu came back to her senses, she heard this sentence, and her heart felt indescribable.

"Okay," she heard herself answer.

Yin Lingzhu couldn't cook meat dishes. The vegetables she had practiced in the afternoon were all vegetarian and didn't taste good either.

She remembered what she used to do when staying up late and couldn't wait for delivery.

So Yin Lingzhu cooked herself plain noodles in clear water, adding nothing.

She was a very lazy person.

Yan Si watched Yin Lingzhu bring out a bowl of noodles and said nothing.

She had seen some wasted dishes in the kitchen.

This meal was eaten in extreme silence.

Yin Lingzhu's heart was tormented. If only she had learned to cook earlier.

Seeing Yan Si finish eating, she hurriedly put down her chopsticks. "What would you like to eat tomorrow? I'll make it for you."

Yan Si took her bowl to the kitchen. "No need. I won't come until the sixth of next month."

Yin Lingzhu was stunned and asked without thinking, "Why?"

The dishwasher in the kitchen was working, making noise. Yan Si's voice sounded: "I'm busy with work."

Hearing this, Yin Lingzhu lowered her head and ate the tasteless noodles.

After Yan Si finished cleaning up the dishes, she walked toward the door.

"Aren't you staying here tonight?" Yin Lingzhu asked, seeing her movement.

"Mm." After Yan Si's cold voice, came the sound of the door closing.

Yin Lingzhu no longer had the mood to eat. She cleaned up the bowl and began learning to stir-fry meat in the kitchen.

The meat had water droplets on it. As soon as it hit the pan, it made a sizzling sound along with countless splashing oil droplets.

Yin Lingzhu's hand was inevitably splattered.

The sudden pain stimulated not just her body, but also her spirit.

Yin Lingzhu couldn't hold back and crouched on the ground, crying softly.

She believed it was her own fault that made Yan Si leave today.

The next day at noon, when Yin Lingzhu woke up and opened her eyes, she felt uncomfortable - her eyes seemed swollen.

She couldn't remember how she had gotten back to the bedroom, only remembering crying for a long time.

She opened her phone and discovered Ji Jingrong had sent her a message.

She said she needed to go to the company to see Brother Wen², so she wanted Yin Lingzhu to take her there.

Yin Lingzhu agreed to take her tonight.

She looked at herself in the mirror and wiped her face. Her eyes were swollen like walnuts, completely unable to see people.

She planned to use the afternoon to recover her eyes. If the swelling really wouldn't go down, there was nothing she could do.

In the evening, Yin Lingzhu sent Ji Jingrong a message, waiting for her at the door.

Her eyes had mostly recovered, with only a little swelling and redness that couldn't be seen without careful observation.

On the road, Yin Lingzhu asked what Ji Jingrong needed.

Ji Jingrong explained a bunch of things, none of which she understood.

Seeing Yin Lingzhu didn't understand, Ji Jingrong didn't continue explaining and changed the topic.

The two gradually shifted from discussing work to talking about life's interesting stories, and their relationship also seemed more intimate.

From entering the company, to asking Brother Wen about things, to finally leaving the company, Yin Lingzhu stayed by Ji Jingrong's side the whole time.

"Why are you guarding me so closely?" Ji Jingrong also noticed Yin Lingzhu's constant presence and joked.

Yin Lingzhu was quite frank about this. "I'm afraid Brother Wen might become desperate³. I'm an Alpha after all, so I'm not afraid of him."

The two didn't choose to take a taxi back to the apartment. Because they needed to buy groceries, they prepared to take a small path to the supermarket.

"Stop."

Passing by an alley entrance, Yin Lingzhu suddenly heard a somewhat familiar voice calling her.

She looked into the alley - it was pitch black, and she couldn't see anything.

Just when she was about to leave, she suddenly felt a push that shoved her into the alley.

Ji Jingrong was also pushed in.

Fear of the darkness made her instinctively grab the hand of the person beside her - it was Ji Jingrong's hand.

Yin Lingzhu felt her palm sweating.

She put on a smile and instinctively called out, "Big Brother."

Big Brother.

This address made her remember the situation from the first day and understand who was in the alley.

"Big Brother, the money I owed you should be paid off," Yin Lingzhu immediately understood what was happening after receiving the original host's memories.

The original host had borrowed five thousand yuan, but even after paying it back bit by bit, this Big Brother still came asking for money every few days.

The original host couldn't afford to offend him, so she could only grit her teeth and accept it.

This five thousand yuan that could never be fully repaid continued until Yin Lingzhu arrived.

Hearing Yin Lingzhu's words, Big Brother snorted coldly. "If I say it's not paid off, then it's not paid off."

Footnotes: ¹ "To capture a person's heart, you must first capture their stomach" (抓住一个人的心, 就要抓住她的胃) - A Chinese saying meaning that the way to someone's affection is through good food.

² Brother Wen (文哥) - A respectful way to address an older male colleague or business contact, where "Wen" is his surname and "ge" means "older brother."

³ "Become desperate" (狗急跳墙) - A Chinese idiom literally meaning "a cornered dog will jump over a wall," referring to someone becoming dangerous when pushed to desperation.